4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: April 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

April 2026 Locked April 2026 is locked (closed 5 May 2026). These numbers won't change.

In short: Jobs made a 47.7% gross margin in April: maintenance contracts the most (63.9%), installations the least (41.8%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

April's jobs made $87,823 gross margin (47.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $24,208 and overheads $59,290, leaving $4,325 profit before tax (2.4% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 45.4% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$87,823
Technician wages and on-costs	$72,352
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$48,144
Technician time not charged to jobs	$24,208
Gross profit (the P&L)	$63,615
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,290
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$4,325
Revenue	$183,967
Gross margin on jobs, %	47.7%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	2.4%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**45.4%**

Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, April · All jobs
47.7%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, March · All jobs
42.2%
target 35.0%

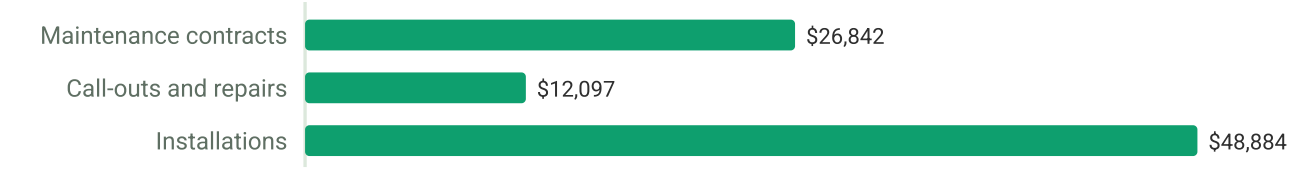
Gross margin jobs need to break even
45.4%
covers overheads and time not charged (April)

Job gross margin by type of job, April 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

In April maintenance contracts made a 63.9% job gross margin, installations made a 41.8% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 48.3% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 45.4% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 41.8% gross margin, 6.8 points over the 35.0% target ($7,969 ahead on $116,900 in April). Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($12,142 ahead on $42,000 in April).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

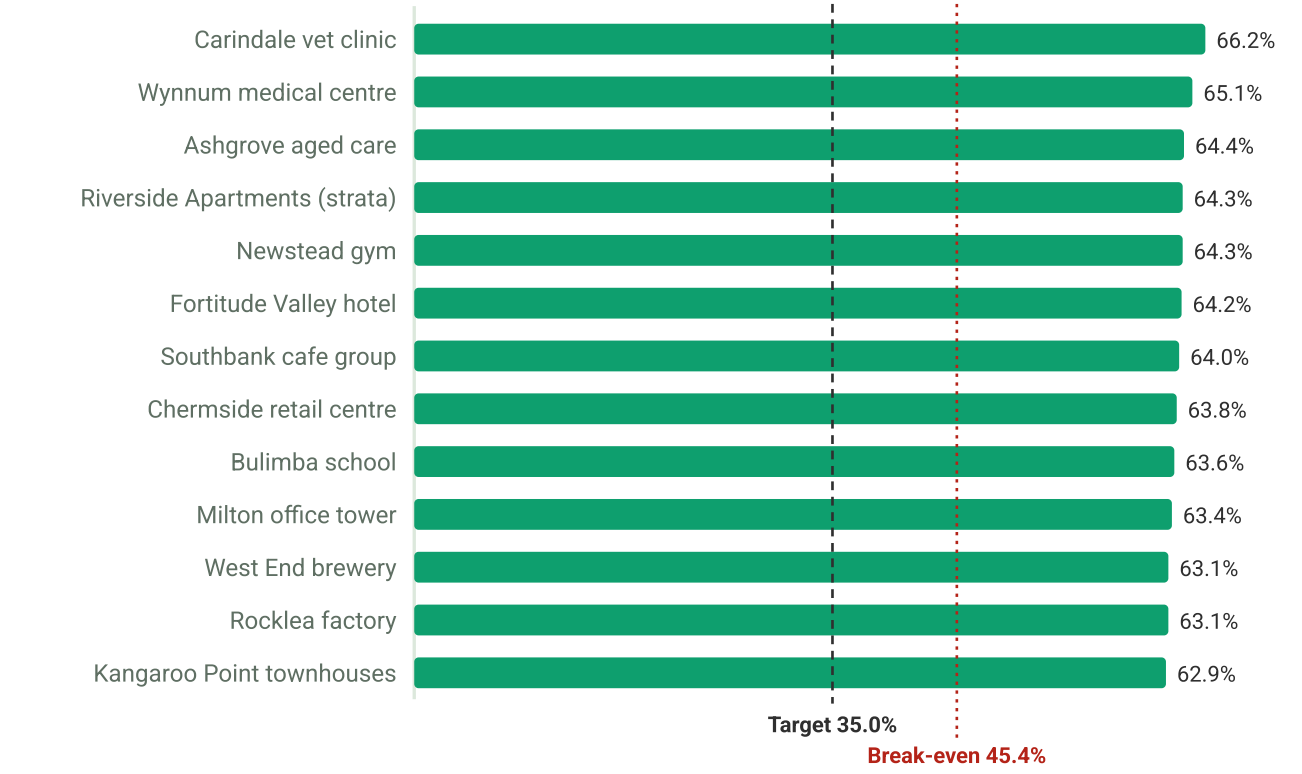
Job gross margin, April · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, March · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

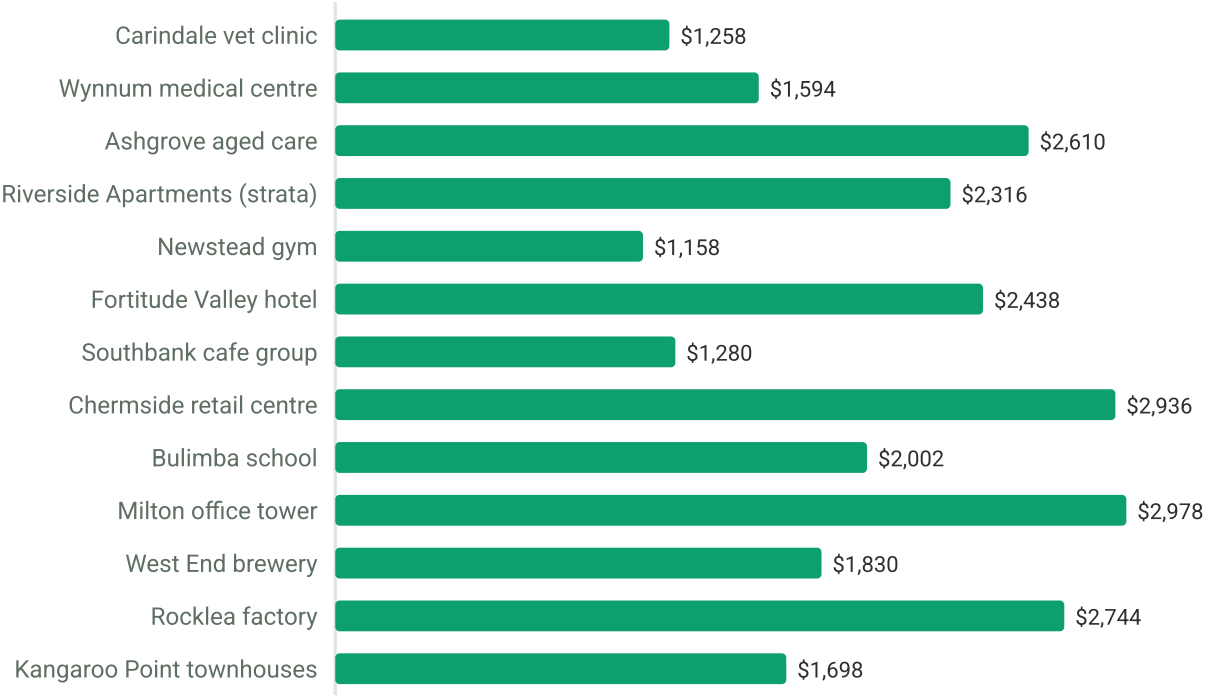
Gross margin jobs need to break even
45.4%
covers overheads and time not charged (April)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, April 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 13 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in April). All maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($12,142 ahead on $42,000 in April).

Type of job: Installations

Job gross margin, April · Installations
41.8%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, March · Installations
34.9%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even
45.4%
covers overheads and time not charged (April)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in April 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

0 of the 3 installation jobs invoiced in April made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Logan Central school switchboard upgrade made a 37.1% job gross margin: 132.0 h of technician time ($8,976) and $3,800 of subcontractors on a $42,600 job. Jobs need 45.4% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Every installation cleared the 35.0% target. Most profitable: Kedron warehouse data cabling (46.2%).

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, April · Call-outs and repairs
48.3%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, March · Call-outs and repairs
47.9%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even
45.4%
covers overheads and time not charged (April)

Technician time charged, April
$17,930
71.5% of call-out revenue

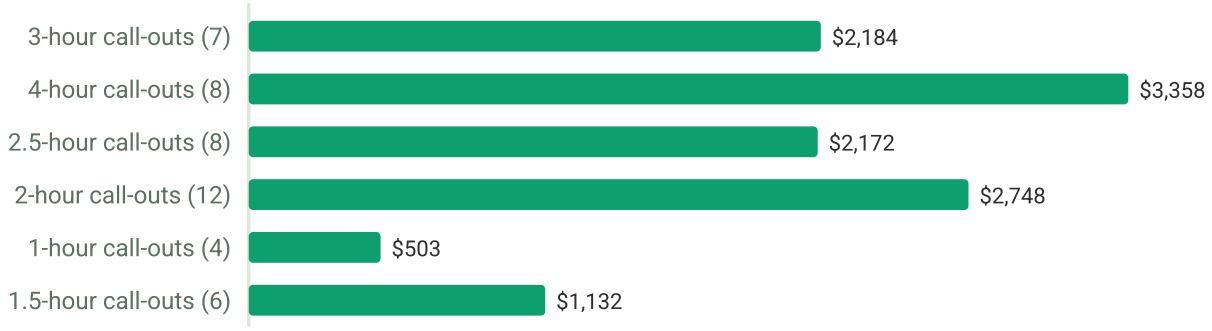
Materials charged, April
$7,137
$5,490 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, April 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

45 call-outs in April billed $17,930 of technician time and $7,137 of materials ($5,490 at cost plus 30%), and made a 48.3% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 42.3% to 51.5% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

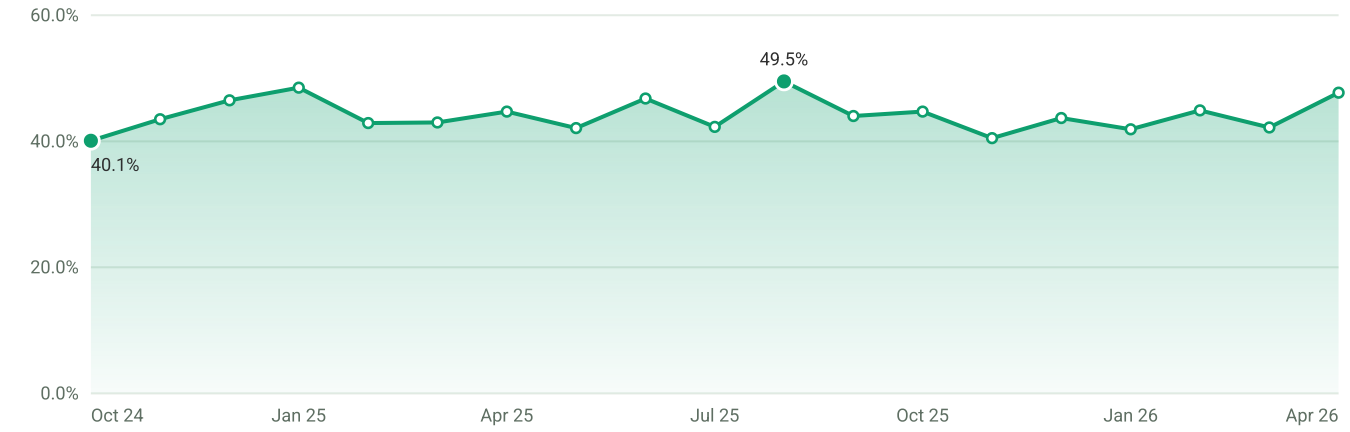
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 48.3% gross margin, 13.3 points over the 35.0% target ($3,324 ahead on $25,067 in April).

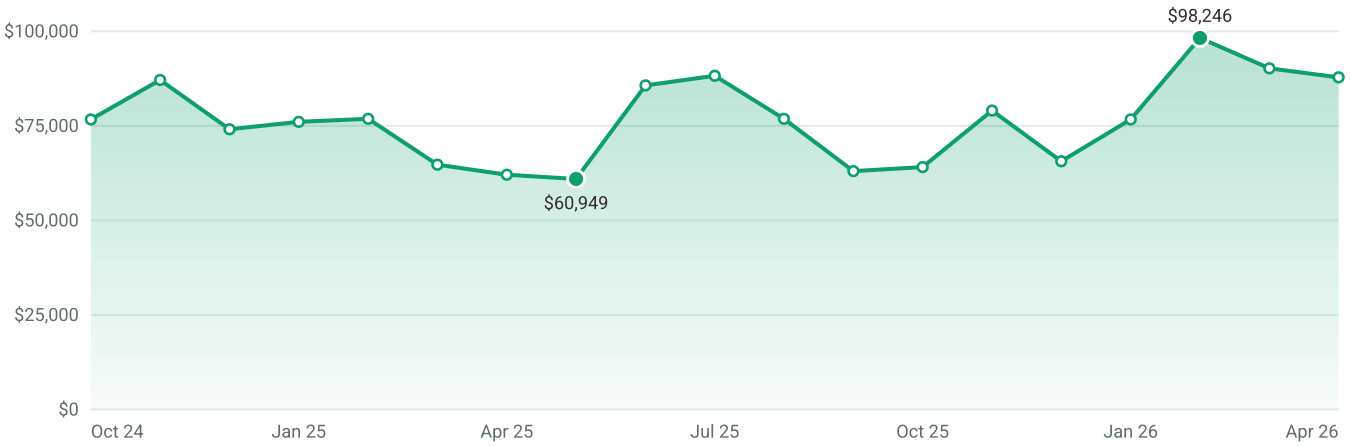
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.